SWRS Southwest Recovery Services

Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

FLIGHT TRAINING & AVIATION SERVICES RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Receivables Recovery for Flight Schools

Recovering unpaid flight-training balances — on pure contingency, without putting your reputation at risk

Prepared for **Front Range Heli, Inc.** · September 2026

01 — INTRODUCTION

The balances that follow a student who stops flying

Rose — thank you for reaching out. You asked about our process, our rates, and whether recovery can be done in a way that protects a five-star reputation. That last question is the one we want to answer first, because it is the one that actually decides whether this works for a business like yours.

A flight-training balance is not an anonymous invoice. The person who owes it sat in your aircraft, flew with your instructors, and in many cases still wants to finish the rating. Handled badly, a $6,000 tuition balance costs you far more than $6,000 — it costs a review, a referral, and a student who tells the other students.

Southwest Recovery Services is an outsourced receivables recovery partner working consumer and commercial balances on **pure contingency since 2004**, from 12 offices across 7 states including Colorado. You place accounts through a secure portal; we work them under documented FDCPA, Reg F and TCPA guardrails. No recovery, no fee.

02 — AT A GLANCE

Two decades of recovery — and a compliance record that holds up

The scale of a national recovery operation, run with the restraint a five-star, referral-driven flight school actually needs.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	**$1.0B+** Receivables placed (all industries)	**$79M+** Recovered for clients	**880K+** Accounts worked
51% of matured client portfolios see a recovery	**50** states — nationwide recovery reach	**4.9★** Google client rating	**$0** upfront — no recovery, no fee

- Commercial & B2B collections since 2004
- Nationwide — all 50 states
- 12 offices across 7 states
- Skip tracing on businesses & principals
- Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY · Financial Services Review · FSR • Top 10 List 2025 Recognition · International Business Times · CFO Tech Outlook · insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED

BBB Better Business Bureau · ACA International · Clutch Top Collections Company United States 2026 · Chamber of Commerce A+ Rated

★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

03 — YOUR QUESTIONS, ANSWERED

Your questions — answered directly

Process, conduct, and rates, in the order you asked them, plus the specifics that matter for a book of flight-training balances between $500 and $25,500.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. How your former students will be treated	This is the first thing we scope, not the last. Every account is worked with respectful, documented, empathy-first contact — no threats, no misrepresentation, no pressure tactics, no contact outside legal hours. Our founding standard is that recovery must preserve goodwill and represent the client professionally, and our conduct is auditable account by account. You can review the outreach we plan to use before a single account is worked.
2. Our recovery process	Placement, then validation, then structured outreach. We confirm the balance against your paperwork (training agreement, block-time purchase, invoices, the communication trail), send the required validation notice, then work a coordinated email, mail, SMS and voice sequence timed to when a person is most likely to engage. Where someone has moved or gone quiet, skip tracing locates current contact data. Most of what resolves does so in the first 30–90 days.
3. Fee structure	Pure contingency — $0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. The rate is driven by the age, balance and volume of what you place; we quote it once we have seen a representative sample of your aging, so the number you get is real rather than a brochure figure.
4. Your $500 to $25,500 range	That spread is normal for flight training and it does not need to be split. Smaller balances respond well to volume-efficient digital outreach; the larger ones — a lapsed block-time purchase or an unfinished commercial rating — justify individual handling, negotiated payment arrangements, and where warranted a review of legal escalation. Same portal, same contingency, different intensity.
5. Disputes and students still on good terms	A dispute pauses recovery; it does not end it. We work it against the paper and speak with both sides. If a former student wants to return and finish the rating, tell us — we will structure the resolution so that the door stays open rather than closing it. That is usually the better commercial outcome for a school your size.
Geography	Recovery reach across all 50 states, which matters because flight students relocate — for work, for a job with a regional, or back home after training. A balance does not become uncollectible because the person left Colorado.

THE SWRS CLIENT PORTAL

Place an account in minutes, then watch it work

Every placement runs through our secure portal, so a small team is never chasing us for a status update.

LOW-LIFT PLACEMENT

Upload a spreadsheet export of the balances — name, contact, balance, dates, what the training was. We map your columns; there is no re-keying.

SECURE DOCUMENT EXCHANGE

Send training agreements, invoices and the email trail safely inside the portal. On flight-training balances the signed agreement is usually what resolves the account.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run status and recovery reports on demand rather than waiting on a monthly statement.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log any payment a former student makes straight to Front Range Heli, so balances stay accurate and nobody is contacted over money they have already paid.

► Portal Video Tour

04 — CASE STUDIES

SWRS Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's book, anonymized by sector and chosen at the scale Front Range Heli would place — including the weaker outcomes, because a partner who only shows you the good ones is not telling you how this works.

AVIATION TRAINING & CHARTER OPERATOR

Flight school & aircraft services

$40K recovered

of ~$125K placed

32% recovered

PRIVATE TRAINING ACADEMY

Single high-balance account

$6.2K recovered

of ~$12K placed

50% recovered

VOCATIONAL & CERTIFICATION PROVIDER

Skills training balances

$5.2K recovered

of ~$18K placed

28% recovered

PRIVATE TUITION SCHOOL

Enrollment arrears

$7.0K recovered

of ~$33K placed

21% recovered

INDEPENDENT SCHOOL

Multi-year tuition arrears

$10K recovered

of ~$61K placed

16% recovered

TRAINING ACADEMY — AGED BOOK

Placed after long in-house effort

$5.7K recovered

of ~$41K placed

14% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

WHAT ACTUALLY MOVES THE NUMBER

Age at placement, not pressure

The spread above is not mostly about effort. It tracks how old the balances were when they were placed. The aviation book at the top was placed while the accounts were still relatively fresh; the 14% book at the bottom was placed after a long in-house collection effort had already exhausted the contact data and the goodwill.

THE AGE CURVE

Balances under roughly 90 days past due often resolve within 30–60 days. The same balance at 18 months recovers a fraction of that — the phone number is dead, the address is stale, and the person has stopped expecting to hear from you.

THE STANDING RULE

A fixed “place at 90 days” policy recovers materially more than letting balances drift toward write-off, and on pure contingency there is no cost to placing early.

Recovery varies by portfolio. SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any account is worked — including telling you when a balance is not worth pursuing.

05 — BUILT FOR FLIGHT TRAINING & AVIATION SERVICES

Protecting the rating you earned from your customers

A five-star reputation is a commercial asset, and it is the reason most flight schools write off money they are owed rather than risk a public complaint. It is a false choice. Firm, compliant, documented recovery and a protected brand are the same discipline, not competing ones.

Unfinished training & lapsed block time

Prepaid hours drawn down and never settled, and students who stop flying mid-rating with a balance outstanding — the two accounts that make up most of a flight school's write-offs.

Students who have moved on

Skip tracing locates former students who have relocated for a regional job or gone home after training, so distance stops being the reason a balance dies.

Commercial and corporate accounts

Charter, aerial-survey, photography and corporate-event invoices are commercial B2B receivables and are worked as such — one partner, one portal, both sides of your book.

Compliance you can point to

FDCPA, Reg F and TCPA guardrails enforced inside the workflow with consent and number checks before contact, documented on every account — the record you need if a former student ever complains.

06 — AI-POWERED COLLECTIONS

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right approach reaches the right person first, without manual queue-picking.

Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS and voice, timed to when someone is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.

Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.

Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.

API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.

Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring predicts payment likelihood and concentrates effort where recovery is achievable — earlier, lighter-touch intervention that resolves accounts before they need escalation.

The result is the combination a reputation-sensitive business rarely gets from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

07 — MEET THE FOUNDER

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

> "Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.
>
> **— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services**

08 — RESOURCES

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.

This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Front Range Heli

Download PDF ↓

Consumer Collections, Done Right

Conduct & compliance · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Placement File Standard

What to send us · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

Download PDF ↓

09 — NEXT STEP

Let’s look at your file before anyone is contacted.

A 30-minute call to walk the outstanding balances, agree exactly how your former students will be approached, and put a contingency rate against a representative sample of your aging.

Book a 30-minute discovery call →

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